

55 Phrasal verbs

Some verbs in English have two or more words in them, and usually have a new meaning when they are used together. These are called phrasal verbs.

See also: Verb patterns with objects **53**
Prepositions **105** Separable phrasal verbs **R20**
Inseparable phrasal verbs **R21**

55.1 PHRASAL VERBS

Phrasal verbs have a verb plus one or more particles (prepositions or adverbs.)
The particle often changes the usual meaning of the verb.

PHRASAL VERB

I **get up** early every day.

Verb Particle



HOW TO FORM

The particle always comes after the verb.
The verb changes form to match the subject as usual. The particle never changes form.

The verb takes the third person "-s."

He **gets up**. ✓

He **get ups**. ✗
This is wrong. The particle should never change.

He **up gets**. ✗
This is wrong. The particle should come after the verb.

FURTHER EXAMPLES

You **work out** at the gym.



My cat sometimes **runs away**.



They don't **eat out** very often.



Do you always **turn up** late?



Questions are formed in the usual way.

Negatives are formed in the usual way.

He **doesn't go out** when he's tired.



She **chills out** in the evening.



We can **check into** the hotel now.



Do they **meet up** most weekends?

